Medicines Management Policy

Version: 1.0 | Effective: [Insert Date] | Review: [Insert Date – usually annually]

Medicines Management Policy

Policy Title: Medicines Management
Effective Date: 2025-09-06
Review Date: 04/2026
Version: 1.0
Applies to: All staff involved in the handling, administration, storage, and disposal of medicines at Sanders

1. Policy Statement

At Sanders, we are committed to the safe, effective, and accountable management of medicines to promote the health and wellbeing of our residents.

This policy ensures compliance with:

- The Medicines Act 1968
- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- Care Quality Commission (CQC) Fundamental Standards
- NHS and local prescribing and medicines management guidance

2. Purpose

This policy aims to:

- Ensure medicines are handled safely and correctly
- Protect residents' rights to receive the correct medicines at the right time
- Minimise risks associated with medicines errors
- Comply with legal and professional standards

3. Scope

This policy applies to all staff who:

- Administer medicines
- Store and order medicines
- Record and report on medicines usage
- Dispose of medicines

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures medicines management policy is implemented and monitored
- Ensures staff are competent and trained in medicines management
- Reports medicines-related incidents to CQC and relevant authorities

Responsible Staff (e.g., Nurses, Care Staff):

- Administer medicines only after appropriate training and competency checks
- Maintain accurate records of medicines administration
- Report and document any errors or adverse reactions

5. Medicines Handling Procedures

5.1 Ordering and Receiving Medicines

- Medicines must be ordered only on valid prescriptions by authorised prescribers
- Check medicines received against the prescription and delivery note
- Report any discrepancies or damaged medicines immediately

5.2 Storage

- Store medicines securely in a locked cupboard or trolley with restricted access
- Maintain appropriate storage conditions (temperature monitoring for fridge items)
- Separate controlled drugs and maintain controlled drug registers

5.3 Administration

- Follow the “Five Rights” of medication administration:
    - Right resident
    - Right medicine
    - Right dose
    - Right time
    - Right route
- Confirm identity using at least two identifiers (e.g., name and date of birth)
- Ensure privacy and dignity during administration

5.4 Documentation

- Complete Medication Administration Records (MAR) accurately and promptly
- Record refusals, missed doses, and any adverse reactions
- Maintain confidentiality of medicines records

5.5 Disposal

- Dispose of unwanted, out-of-date, or unused medicines according to local protocols
- Controlled drugs must be disposed of in line with legal requirements and witnessed
- Maintain disposal records

6. Controlled Drugs (CDs)

- Maintain a controlled drugs register for all CDs received, administered, or disposed
- Only authorised staff may access CDs
- Conduct regular audits of CDs
- Report discrepancies or theft immediately to management and authorities

7. Resident Involvement

- Respect residents' rights to be involved in decisions about their medicines
- Provide information and support about medicines as appropriate
- Record any allergies or adverse drug reactions

8. Training and Competency

- All staff involved in medicines management will receive training at induction and refresher courses annually
- Competency assessments are carried out regularly
- Records of training and competency must be maintained

9. Incident Reporting

- All medicines errors, near misses, and adverse events must be reported immediately
- Investigations will be conducted, and learning shared to improve practice
- Report serious incidents to the CQC as per regulations

10. Monitoring and Audit

- Regular audits of medicines storage, administration, and records will be conducted
- Action plans will be developed to address any areas of non-compliance

11. Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Consent Policy
- Infection Prevention and Control Policy
- Staff Training and Development Policy

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